

ClassE US language guide

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Why this matters

Purpose: This guide flags the words a US educator can hear as outdated, controversial or unintentionally offensive, and gives the word to use instead, in every call, demo, deck and email.

Goal: US buyers hear a partner who shares their beliefs about students and teachers, and they trust ClassE with their students.

US buyers are skeptical of edtech. Many have been burned before, so they look for signals, good or bad. They answer to their community for every choice they make with public money. A district that buys ClassE is saying, "This is the best place to spend public funds for our kids." So we have to be above reproach.

What matters most is not the words. It is the mindsets behind them, and these beliefs are ours. This guide helps us say them the way US educators say them.

Most of the lines under "Sounds like" come from our own calls, including some of Christopher's. They work in Israel. A US buyer hears them differently, so we keep the idea and change the words.

Read the first two pages before a call. Check the word list before a deck or email goes out.

Our core beliefs

1. **Every child can, and will, grow.** Every child can make radical growth in the right conditions. Our job is to help build those conditions.
2. **Kids do well if they can.** This is an idea from Ross Greene, a US psychologist. A student who is struggling is missing a skill, not the will. When a student has a learning gap, it means we have not found the right way yet. Never, ever because the kid does not want to.
3. **We never blame students or families.** Nothing we say can be heard as blaming kids or not believing in them. We never blame parents. Families are our partners.
4. **Every student is an individual.** We see each student as an individual. We never generalize about a child from a group or from one story. A student's culture, language and community are strengths the student brings.

Three things to remember

- "We help the student up to the question. We don't bring the question down to the student." The line used to say "test." "Question" keeps it from sounding like teaching to the test, and "help" tells a special education or English learner specialist that students get support to get there. It is about ClassE's own questions. School teams will always be able to accommodate and modify a student's work.
- "The teacher leads. ClassE supports."
- "We don't have a study on that yet. Here's what we can show you."

Words we use

These land well with US educators. Several came out of our September workshop.

- **For what ClassE does:** targeted practice, personalized practice and feedback, the second question, data-informed, curriculum-aligned (where ClassE is set up for that curriculum), accessibility supports
- **For what the teacher does:** targeted instruction, small-group follow-up, reteach and reinforce, next steps
- **For students:** a student with a disability, English learner or multilingual learner, students who have not shown this skill yet
- **For results:** a correct response, score band, performance level

Seven kinds of words that land wrong

Kind	Sounds like	Say instead
Labels a child. Ranks kids, or turns them into a group.	"Closing the gaps with the weakest students."	"Seven students missed this skill. The teacher can teach them in a small group."
Out of date. Sounds careless in a US school today.	"Your ESL students."	"Your English learners." In Texas, "your emergent bilingual students."
Undercuts teachers. Says the teacher is the problem.	"The platform is teacher-proof."	"The teacher leads. ClassE supports."
The district's word. A vendor overstepping a legal or formal process.	"We can do 10 exercises and diagnose exactly what the problem is."	"The student got these questions wrong on this skill. This is where we focus next."
Politically charged. Takes a side the buyer did not ask about.	"An equity engine that dismantles traditional testing and builds belonging."	What ClassE does for each student. Follow the buyer's lead.
Unmeasured claim or sales talk. A skeptical buyer asks how we know.	"Thousands of kids that use ClassE in Israel have better grades."	"Schools in Israel use it. We don't have a controlled study of its effect on grades yet."
Sounds translated. Understood, but marks the speaker as not from here.	"An exercise platform."	"Practice."

Use the buyer's word first. Never correct how a buyer talks about its own students, and never repeat what one district says about itself to another.

Before the call

- Check the state, and whether you are meeting a district, a charter network or one school. Then read "Texas and New York, side by side."
- If a report on screen says "mastery," say what it shows: "These students got this question right."
- Do not mention Albert or text to speech until the team confirms they work in the US product.

- If teachers are in the room, talk to them, not about them: "You see which students missed which skill. You decide what to do next."

If a word goes wrong in the call

- "What do you call this in your schools?"
- "I may be missing local context. How does this work in your schools?"
- "Let me say that more carefully."
- "I don't know. I'll find out and get back to you."

If a buyer asks

- "So you're like i-Ready?" "Some parts are similar. Let's show you what happens after a student misses a question."

Texas and New York, side by side

The same word can be safe in one state and risky in the other.

	Texas	New York and the Northeast
Law and policy	SB 12, a Texas law limiting DEI work in K-12 schools, in effect since September 1, 2025.	The Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education Framework, New York State guidance since 2018.
Equity words	Do not raise equity, DEI or identity words. If the district uses one, follow its lead.	Many schools use equity, identity and asset framing words. Some have grown quieter about them since 2025. Follow the buyer's lead. Using a buyer's own words is not the same as raising DEI.
How to open	"ClassE gives students practice on the TEKS, once we set it up with you."	"ClassE gives students practice on your curriculum and your standards, once we set it up with you."
State test	STAAR. Its top level is "Masters Grade Level," so Texas educators say "masters" as an official label. Never use "mastery" for a ClassE result.	The New York State tests.
English learners	"Emergent bilingual" for the student. "ESL" or "bilingual" for the program.	"Multilingual learners/English language learners (MLLs/ELLs)" for the student. "ENL" for the program.

Word list, A to Z

Look up a word before you use it.

Word or phrase	Say instead	Why
"Acceleration," for ClassE	"Targeted practice." Use "acceleration" only for the district's own program.	In Texas it is a program set in law, with minimum hours and tutor ratios.

Word or phrase	Say instead	Why
"Accommodate" and "modify," mixed up	"Accommodation" when the student reaches the same work another way. "Modification" when the work itself changes.	In US special education they are different decisions, and the student's IEP or 504 team makes them. Mixing them up signals we don't know the system.
"ADHD students," "cognitive issues," "students with different diagnosed learning disabilities"	"A student with a disability," or what the student needs.	A student's disability category is private.
AI hype: "a revolution in education," "30 personalized tutors that know your students"	Describe what the AI does. "Albert, the AI tutor, asks the student questions, so the student works it out."	No one can check it.
"Any curriculum"	"Curriculum-aligned," only where ClassE is set up for that curriculum.	A buyer will test it on their own curriculum.
"Assessment platform," "diagnostic and remediation tool"	"Practice." Then describe the second question.	The first label decides which product the buyer compares ClassE to. Buyers who heard these said, "Oh, so you're i-Ready."
"At risk," "low performing," about a student	"Students who have not shown this skill yet."	In Texas, at risk is a legal category. Low performing is a federal term for schools.
"Bring the students to the test," "the exact model of what they're going to see on that test"	"We help the student up to the question." "We align the practice to your standards and your state assessment."	It sounds like teaching to the test.
"Competency issues," "needs help," "competent," about a student	"This student missed these three questions."	It labels the child. Describe the answers.
"Data-driven"	"Data-informed."	It sounds like the numbers make the decisions.
"Depends a lot on the quality of the teachers"	Do not raise it.	It judges the buyer's staff.
"Diagnose," "diagnostic," for ClassE	"The student got these questions wrong on this skill. This is where we focus next."	It sounds like a disability evaluation, which only the district runs, with the parent's consent.
"Drill and kill," or any other product, run down	Describe what ClassE does.	The district may use that product.
Equity, DEI, "culturally responsive"	Follow the buyer's lead. Never use them for ClassE.	In Texas, state law limits DEI work. In either state, never describe ClassE as doing equity work itself.
"ESL students," "LEP"	"English learner" or "multilingual learner." In Texas, "emergent bilingual."	ESL is a program, not a name for a child. Federal law replaced LEP.
"Exactly where the student's reasoning is breaking down"	"Here are the questions the student got wrong on this skill."	It claims to see inside the student's head.
"Exercises," "marks"	"Practice," "scores."	They read as translated.

Word or phrase	Say instead	Why
"I don't see color"	Do not raise race.	It is an older American idea of equality. Today it can sound like not seeing the student.
"Intervention," "intervention platform," for ClassE	"Targeted practice." "ClassE provides data a district may use within its MTSS process."	A US buyer hears a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program. The teacher intervenes. ClassE does not.
"Mastered," "proficient," "masters of this skill," for a ClassE result	"A correct response." Over time: "They got most questions on this standard right, over several weeks."	These are state test labels. One question cannot carry them.
"Meets FERPA," "meets WCAG," or any standard	"I'll find out and get back to you."	Not until the product team confirms it. Buyers worry about student data inside an AI system.
"Neurodivergent student," as the general term	What the student needs.	It is a word some people use about themselves. Follow the family's lead.
One student's story as proof	"That's one student's result. It's not proof yet."	One story is not evidence, and it generalizes from one child.
"Progress monitoring," for ClassE	Describe the evidence in plain words.	It is the district's process, tied to IEP goals and tiered support.
"Proven," "evidence-based," "ESSA certified"	"We don't have a study on that yet. Here's what we can show you." "Evidence-informed design."	ESSA tiers rate studies, and no product is ESSA certified. A buyer will ask for the study.
"Remediation," for ClassE	"Targeted practice." Use "remediation" if the district says it first.	It is the district's word to choose.
"The same difficulty," for the second question	"A second question on the same skill."	No field-test data or item statistics show it yet.
"Saves a lot of time for teachers"	"It takes grading tasks off the teacher's plate."	No number yet, and a principal may hear the teacher will have nothing to do.
"Special needs kids," "SPED student," "special accommodations"	"A student with a disability." For ClassE features: "accessibility supports," once confirmed for the US.	Name the student first. Accessibility is not special education.
"Teacher-proof," "make them better teachers," "faster than teachers"	"The teacher leads. ClassE supports." "ClassE shows the teacher sooner which students missed which skill."	In some countries "teacher-proof" is a selling point. In a US school it says the teacher is the problem.
"These kids"	"Let's look at what each student did."	It turns individual students into a group.
Tiers: "a Tier 1 type of remediation," "your Tier 3 kids," "tier to tier" for scores	Tiers only for what the district runs. For scores: "score band," "performance level."	Tiers are the district's system, never a name for ClassE or a student.
"Upload an IEP"	Do not offer it.	An IEP is a confidential student record.
"Weak students," "strong students," "a GAP student," "a pretty good student"	"Each student gets practice on the skill they missed."	It ranks children. Praise is still a judgment.

For the product team

Some of these words are on the screen, not just in the pitch, and a rep can't talk around them in a demo.

- The report says "mastery" off one question. Decide what it calls a correct answer, and what it calls a skill shown over time.
- "Exercise" in the product. It reads as translated to a US teacher.
- If the product labels students with words like "needs help" or "competent," describe what the student did instead.

US terms and sources

Terms: 504 plan, a plan under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act for a student with a disability who needs accommodations. ENL, English as a New Language, the New York program name. ESSA, Every Student Succeeds Act, which sets the evidence tiers. FERPA, Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, on student records. IDEA, Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, the special education law. IEP, Individualized Education Program. MTSS, Multi-Tiered System of Supports. STAAR, the Texas state test. TEKS, Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills, the Texas standards. WCAG, Web Content Accessibility Guidelines.

Sources: at risk, Texas Education Code 29.081. Emergent bilingual, Texas Education Code 29.052. Acceleration, Texas HB 4545 and HB 1416. LEP, replaced by "English learner" in ESSA (2015). SB 12, in effect September 1, 2025. STAAR, to be replaced by shorter tests under a 2025 Texas law. New York student data, Education Law 2-d requires a data privacy agreement before a district can use the product. Neurodivergent, not one of the 13 IDEA disability categories. Kids do well if they can, Ross Greene.